

of the error it presents a unique opportunity to identify the numerous design, development and specially deployment flaws that have coupled together to create this nightmare. First and foremost, a script to remove the contents of a folder using the 'rm' command without taking a backup to an offsite location, especially in a production environment is careless to the point of being dumb. Next, any script, maintenance, release, patch or testing needs to go through design, develop and test phases (yes even shell scripts for deployment) without which we will never be able to guarantee its behaviour.

Thirdly, there are perhaps hundreds of other ways of cleaning up a folder location than using a combination of variables (that can potentially have other values associated to them) and a `rm -rf` command.

The fact that such a situation can occur in today's age of deployment automation is cringe-worthy and perhaps the forum was right when it collectively advised the person who posted this to start looking for a lawyer as he really had 'killed' his company with a single command. 